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The Sunday of All Saints



The Holy Fathers established the commemoration of this feast after the descent of the Holy Spirit in order to show that the coming of the most Holy Spirit worked enormous deeds through the Apostles, sanctifying and bestowing wisdom upon those who were like us, and setting these saints in the place of those angels who had fallen, leading them, through Jesus Christ, to God. Some came through blood, while

other were led through their virtuous way of life, but all were perfected through the Holy Spirit.

Just a short time before this, the Body that had been assumed and deified by God the Word was lifted up and seated at the right of the Father's glory; and now, according to the promise, He draws to Himself all who desire to come, according to His dispensation.

Also, in this feast we honor many others who, although pleasing to God, have, for whatever reasons or circumstances, remained unknown to all, even though they are greatly glorified before God. In addition, there are many who lived according to the will of God throughout all the world – those whom it was not easy to make known – because of the vastness of their numbers.

Therefore in order that we also may receive the intercessions of all who have been pleasing to God from

**Sunday, June 7, 2026
Divine Liturgy Sundays at 9:30 AM
Confessions before Liturgy
Coffee Hour after Liturgy – bring a snack to share**

Sunday of All Saints Всех Святых

every part of the earth, as well as to honor those Saints who will later be added to the calendar, the Holy Fathers have established this Feast of All Saints, encompassing all, from the earliest saints to the most recent, from those who are well-known to those who are unknown, sanctified by the Holy Spirit Who rests in them.

Also, it was necessary that a single day be set aside for all the Saints, even those who are commemorated separately throughout the year, thus showing that they all struggled for one single Christ and that all found themselves on the same paths of virtue and were thus crowned in worthiness as servants of the one single God. They form the Church Triumphant, filling the world above and encouraging us to strive ahead in this same \ battle, which varies in many ways for each individual according to his strength

Thus, on this day we celebrate all that the Holy Spirit has sanctified – all the saints, men and women, known and unknown, from all the ages. But above all we honor the holiest of the holies, the most holy and incomparable one who is more glorious than the angels – our Lady Theotokos and ever-virgin Mary. *(from the Synaxarion)*

В прошлое воскресенье мы праздновали день Пятидесятницы, день схождения Святого Духа, день рождения Церкви Христовой. А сегодня мы созерцаем результаты действия Святого Духа в человеческой истории, видим те плоды, которые принесла Церковь в людских душах. Мы отмечаем день Всех святых.

Святых так много, как звезд на небе, есть среди них известные по именам и подвигам, и неизвестные, ведомые только Богу. ...Есть книга «Синаксарь», в котором по возможности рассказано о каждом из святых, которые на сегодняшний день открыты и прославлены Церковью. Иногда это только имя и всего лишь несколько строк о жизни человека. Но в совокупности это дает впечатляющую картину духовного звездного неба, многообразной святости. Здесь есть святые императоры и домохозяйки, полководцы и земледельцы, монахи-аскеты и благочестивые праведники.

Звезда от звезды разнится в славе. Есть великие святые, подвигам которых мы можем только удивляться, но подражать – только на малую часть. Таковы, например, преподобный Антоний Великий или преподобный Сергей Радонежский. Мы можем ими восхищаться, можем усвоить дух и настроение

их подвижнической жизни, но повторить их труды и подвиги было бы желанием весьма самонадеянным.

Однако есть и такие святые, жизнь которых, казалось бы, не так уж сильно отличается от нашей, просто они в определенный момент всего себя вверили Богу, и «сокровенный сердца человек» стал подлинным христианином, в полном значении этого слова.

Говорит не просто устами, а полным изменением своего взгляда на жизнь, исправлением своего бытия. В жизни каждого есть место ошибкам и заблуждениям, большинство из нас не избежало и тяжелых согрешений, но если мы хотим быть христианами, то мы призваны к святости, это практически синонимы. Об этом постоянно говорит в своих посланиях апостол Павел. Например, так: Бог «избрал нас прежде создания мира, чтобы мы были святы и непорочны пред Ним в любви» (*Еф. 1, 4*). То же самое утверждает апостол Петр: «По примеру призвавшего вас Святого и сами будьте святы во всех поступках» (*1 Петра, 1, 15*).

С нынешнего дня, с настоящего часа для нас открыта эта дверь – подлинно стать христианами. Блж. Августин сравнивал наше постоянное откладывание своего исправления – завтра! завтра! – с карканьем ворона. Долго мы еще будем каркать? Почему бы нам не исправиться? Почему не сегодня? Почему не сейчас?.. Святость – это наше призвание, это наш категорический императив, без выполнения которого мы не можем называться христианами.

Иеромонах Симеон (Томачинский)

“Guard your heart!” These words were spoken in the past by experienced ascetics. Father John of Kronstadt says the same thing in our days: “The heart is refined, spiritual and heavenly by nature. Guard it. Do not overburden it; do not make it earthly; be temperate to the utmost in food and drink, and in bodily pleasures in general. The heart is the temple of God. *If any man defile the temple of God, him shall God destroy* (1 Cor. 3:17). Spiritual experience in ancient times and spiritual experience in our time is identical, under the condition that the confession of faith is identical. The heavenly knowledge to which the ascetics of old attained does not differ from that to which the ascetics of today attain. For, as Christ is the same today and tomorrow, so it is with human nature. The main thing is: the human heart is the same; its thirst and its hunger are the same; and nothing is able to satisfy it but the glory, power and riches of God. (*from the Prologue of Ohrid*)

never escape suffering. "In the world you will have tribulation; but be of good cheer," says Christ as He parts from His disciples (John 16:33). Christianity does not call for suffering for the sake of suffering itself, yet evil cannot be conquered by the fear of enduring suffering. The world is full of suffering, and Christianity—always realistic—asserts that evil will not retreat of its own accord and that anyone who engages in the struggle against it will never escape suffering. "In the world you will have tribulation; but be of good cheer," says Christ as He parts from His disciples (John 16:33). Christianity does not call for suffering for the sake of suffering itself, yet evil cannot be conquered by the fear of enduring suffering.

HOMILY FOR THE SUNDAY OF ALL SAINTS

Sunday we celebrated the Descent of the Holy Spirit and the establishment of Christ's Church on earth, while today we celebrate the fruits of this grace-filled Church – today is the Sunday of All Saints, who provide us with an extraordinary example of how to live on earth correctly, in order to attain the Kingdom of Heaven. Let us look, dear brethren, at how these saints lived and how they reached paradise.

All the saints who are commemorated today followed the way of Christ, and all of them – in their own time and in their own circumstances of life – fulfilled God's commandment of love for God and one's brethren. And often their times were quite difficult, sometimes even more difficult than ours, and often the circumstances of their lives were spiritually more dangerous and physically worse than ours. And yet they went on, they struggled... and so they reached the Kingdom of Heaven, where they are now triumphant.

Look at the walls of the church and you will see them: martyrs, confessors, righteous men, fools for Christ, the educated, the simple, the rich, the poor, prelates, monks, laymen... Look at how many stars are shining on the Lord's spiritual firmament. This is the heavenly Church. It is universal, and it is constantly being reinforced from the earthly Church, where all of us are members, dear brethren. There is a place for everyone there. This is what today's reading from the Epistle teaches us: “Wherefore, seeing such a cloud of witnesses surrounding us, let us lay aside every weight and the sin that besets us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us, looking unto Jesus, the Author of our faith.” (*Adapted from “The One Thing Need-” Archbishop Andrew of Novo-Diveevo*)

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